

Proposal for Emoji: Kidney

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Identification

Suggested name: Kidney

Suggested keywords: renal; anatomy; organ; filtration; urine; hydration; dialysis; transplant; donation; stone; bean-shaped

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

The paradigm shows one large kidney with a pronounced hilum, a short renal-vessel cue, and a tan ureter. The single bold specimen remains legible at small sizes, while the hilum and plumbing cues distinguish the organ from a food bean. Vendors may simplify shading but should preserve the medial notch and at least one short attached structure.

I, Shuhan He, certify that these example images are original work created for this proposal, that I own all IP Rights in them, and that they contain no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text. I release the images under the CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication and grant the rights required by the Unicode Emoji Proposal Agreement and License.

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Kidney has established meanings beyond a literal anatomical reference. Kidney names kidney beans and appears in the conventional descriptor kidney-shaped for pools, tables, dishes, and other objects. These extended meanings are familiar without depending on a pun or a temporary campaign.

Merriam-Webster records kidney-shaped as an adjective meaning shaped like a kidney: <https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/kidney-shaped>

B. Use in sequences

Kidney can combine with existing emoji to create messages without standardized sequences:

- Kidney + droplet: hydration, urine production, or filtration.
- Kidney + warning: kidney stone, abnormal result, or urgent kidney concern.
- Kidney + hospital or pill: kidney care, dialysis, treatment, or medication review.
- Kidney + people or heart: donation, transplant, recipient, caregiver, or support.
- Kidney + book or microscope: anatomy, school science, or laboratory testing.
- Kidney + bean or cooking pot: kidney beans or food context.

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. No current emoji represents the kidneys or urinary-system anatomy. A bean primarily represents food; a droplet is ambiguous among water, sweat, tears, blood, and urine; and hospital, pill, and syringe represent places or interventions rather than the organ. Kidney would therefore add a distinct internal-organ concept and enable messages that cannot be expressed clearly with existing emoji.

D. Distinctiveness

The large maroon organ body, medial hilum, and attached vessel or ureter make the proposed paradigm visually distinct from the existing beans emoji. Beans are presented as food and have no anatomical plumbing; the proposed image is one wet-organ specimen with a pronounced notch and a short tan ureter. The 18x18 versions preserve the dominant organ silhouette and attachment cue. Color is helpful but not required: the black-and-white example remains identifiable by structure.

E. Expected usage level

Kidney is used in ordinary conversations about anatomy, hydration, urine, stones, laboratory results, dialysis, transplant, living donation, medication safety, school science, and family health. The five frequency screenshots required by Unicode are embedded below. Google Trends and Google Books compare kidney with Unicode's reference term elephant.

Google Search

Captured 2026-05-13. The result page reports about 211,000,000 results. Reproducible query: <http://www.google.com/search?q=kidney&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

The screenshot shows a Google search for "kidney". The search bar at the top contains the word "kidney". Below the search bar, there are tabs for "All", "Images", "Videos", "Shopping", "News", "Short videos", "More", and "Tools". The "All" tab is selected. The search results show "About 211,000,000 results (0.16s)". The first result is "Human Kidney Anatomy" with a thumbnail image showing the internal and external views of a kidney. Below this, there is a paragraph describing the function of kidneys: "Kidneys are two bean-shaped organs, about the size of a fist, located on either side of the spine just below the rib cage. They filter roughly 37 gallons of blood daily to remove waste and extra water, maintaining fluid, salt, and mineral balance while producing urine. Key functions also include regulating blood pressure, stimulating red blood cell production, and managing bone health." To the right of this paragraph, there is a sidebar with "Related information" including "n, Anatomy, Function & Health", "Cleveland Clinic", "National Kidney Foundation", and "Kidney Disease - NIDDK". Below the main search results, there is a "People also ask" section with four questions: "What are the first signs of a kidney problem?", "What is the best drink to flush your kidneys?", "What are the three early warning signs of a kidney?", and "What drinks are hardest on the kidneys?".

Google

kidney

AI Mode All Images Videos Shopping News Short videos More Tools

AI Overview

Human Kidney Anatomy

External View Internal View

Any time All results Advanced Search

About 211,000,000 results (0.16s)

n, Anatomy, Function & Health

Where are your they located? Your kidneys sit just below your rib cage and in your lower back. Typically...

Cleveland Clinic

National Kidney Foundation

Kidney Disease - NIDDK

Kidneys are two bean-shaped organs, about the size of a fist, located on either side of the spine just below the rib cage. They filter roughly 37 gallons of blood daily to remove waste and extra water, maintaining fluid, salt, and mineral balance while producing urine. Key functions also include regulating blood pressure, stimulating red blood cell production, and managing bone health.

Key Kidney Functions & Health

- Filtration:** Using millions of tiny units called nephrons, kidneys filter waste and excess water from the blood, which then travels to the bladder through ureters.

Show more

Cleveland Clinic

<https://my.clevelandclinic.org/body/21824-kidney>

Kidneys: Location, Anatomy, Function & Health

Nov 5, 2025 — Your kidneys are organs that filter your blood. They remove waste and balance your body's fluids, among other tasks. Most people have one kidney ... [Read more](#)

People also ask

What are the first signs of a kidney problem?

What is the best drink to flush your kidneys?

What are the three early warning signs of a kidney?

What drinks are hardest on the kidneys?

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-05-13. The result page reports about 66,000,000 results. Reproducible query: <https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=kidney&hl=en&num=10&pws=0>

The screenshot shows a Google search interface with the query 'kidney' in the search bar. The 'Videos' tab is selected in the navigation bar. A dropdown menu is open from the 'Tools' button, showing filters for duration, time, quality, videos, source, and an 'Advanced Search' option. The search results list several videos about kidney function and diseases, including 'How Do Kidneys Work?', 'Get to Know Your Kidneys', 'Kidney Function', 'How Your Kidneys Work', 'How kidneys work', and 'Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease'. Each result includes a video thumbnail, a title, a brief description, and the source/channel name and upload date.

Google kidney

AI Mode All Images News Videos Shopping Books More Tools

www.youtube.com › watch
How Do Kidneys Work?
For more information about the function of kidneys, please see
<https://cle.clinic/3RCqSr3> Your kidneys are your body's cle...
YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Jun 19, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch
Get to Know Your Kidneys
Did you know your kidneys filter all of your blood up to 25 times a day? No matter your age, or whether you have kidney disease, getting to ...
YouTube · National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases (NIDDK) · Feb 26, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch
Kidney Function
KidneyFunction #RenalFunction #UrineProduction This is a repost of a video from 2024 to test the new YouTube auto dubbing feature, ...
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · Apr 29, 2025

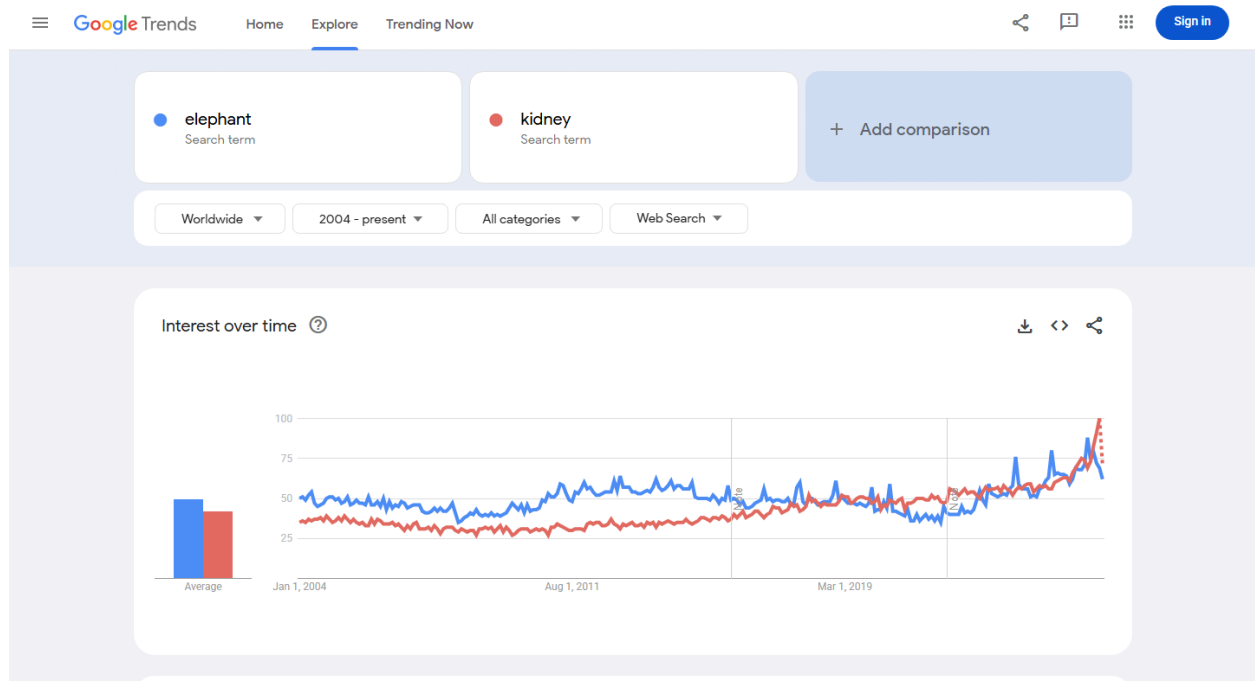
www.youtube.com › watch
How Your Kidneys Work
MEDICAL ANIMATION TRANSCRIPT: The kidneys are located on either side of the spinal column in the posterior abdominal wall.
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · May 16, 2024

www.mayoclinic.org › multimedia › vid-20207497
How kidneys work
How kidneys work – Animation shows how kidneys filter blood, removing waste and extra fluid, which are then carried out of the body in urine.
Mayo Clinic · Mayo Clinic · Mar 25, 2021

www.youtube.com › watch
Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease
Learning about kidney disease can be intimidating. Let our experts walk you through the facts, the questions, and the answers to help you ...
YouTube · Mayo Clinic · Dec 16, 2021

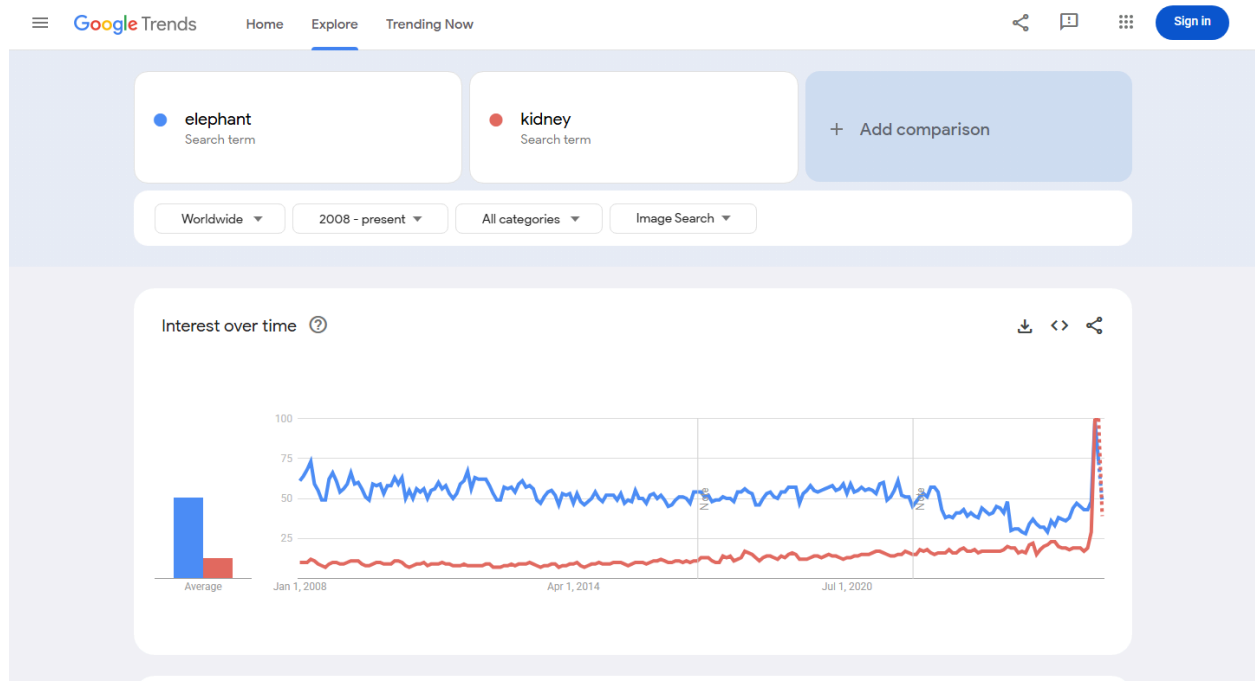
Google Trends - Web Search

Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide and 2004-present. Kidney is of the same order as elephant and reaches comparable or greater recent interest. Reproducible query: <https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=elephant,kidney>



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide and 2008-present. The graph shows sustained kidney image-search interest against elephant. Reproducible query: https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&gprop=images&q=elephant,kidney



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Kidney exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. Reproducible query: https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Ckidney&year_start=1500&year_end=2022&corpus=en&smoothing=3



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Kidney is independently useful and is not proposed merely to complete a set of organs.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already representable

Kidney is not represented by an existing emoji. Bean cannot serve as a clear substitute in anatomical, donation, transplant, dialysis, testing, or medication contexts. General medical emoji identify care but not the organ.

B. Overly specific

Kidney is a primary organ and a broad everyday concept, not a particular disease, procedure, specialty, organization, campaign, or brand. Its uses span body anatomy, health, filtration, hydration, stones, donation, transplant, food language, and education.

C. Open-ended

This proposal does not request a complete anatomy taxonomy. Kidney is supported by its own frequency, multiple meanings, visual distinctiveness, and lack of an adequate substitute. Other organs can be judged independently on the same criteria.

D. Transient

Kidney anatomy, hydration, stones, disease, dialysis, transplant, donation, and kidney-shaped language are durable concepts rather than a temporary event or trend.

E. Faulty comparison

The proposal does not argue that kidney should be encoded merely because heart, lungs, or brain exist. Those emoji only demonstrate that anatomical organs can be legible at emoji scale. Kidney's case rests on its own expected usage and expressive gap.

Other Information

The singular name Kidney is concise and searchable. Essential design cues are one clearly organic maroon form, a medial indentation, and a short vessel or ureter cue that prevents the image from reading as food. Fine vascular detail is optional and should yield to legibility at 18x18.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>